



Douglas T. Breeden
William W. Priest
Professor of Finance
and former Dean

Duke University
The Fuqua School of Business
100 Fuqua Drive
Box 90120
Durham, NC 27708-0120 USA

Tel (919) 660-2892
Doug.Breeden@duke.edu
www.fuqua.duke.edu

November 12, 2025

Recommendation of Rong Wang, Duke PhD candidate, by Douglas Breeden

Rong Wang is one of the 5 very best Teaching Assistants that I have ever worked with in my long career, 1977-2025, 48 years, teaching at Chicago, Stanford, MIT and Duke. I was also the Dean at Duke's Fuqua School of Business 2001-2007. I have no doubt that Rong will be an exceptional teacher in his career. He is talented and knowledgeable, caring, personable, and speaks English flawlessly.

In my final years of teaching, I have taught what Duke most needed me to teach, which included core finance for the Masters in Quantitative Management (MQM) program, which is quite a profitable program for the school, so very important. As I had not taught core finance in almost 40 years, Rong led me through the current, very fine, modular teaching materials, cases, and team exercises that have been developed and improved over many years by our outstanding younger faculty. For my extra contribution, I wrote 6 Supplementary Notes that I also taught, which reflected my applied knowledge from my real world businesses. The students loved this combination of new and applied, and we received 6.5 out of 7.0 top evaluations, quite superb. On each case or team exercise, I handed over the class to Rong to do the student presentations, followed by his presentation of our recommended student analysis, Rong was truly fine in conducting these cases and presentations, so I had no worries.

Duke also asked me to teach MBA Investments again, as I had done both at Chicago and Stanford over 40 years ago. This was more challenging to me, as we had recruited a very sharp young professor, Nuno Clara, from London Business School, who built this course beautifully and with all modern technology and insights. Right before classes began in September 2023, I fell down stairs and broke my ankle badly and had surgery and was in a wheel chair. So I relied upon Rong's guidance even more during that very difficult time teaching. Rong was again superb.

So I am quite certain that Rong Wang has outstanding teaching skills, and I give him my highest recommendation.

Sincerely,
Douglas T. Breeden

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Douglas T. Breeden". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style.